

TWENTY STINGERS · CLAUDE · ROUND THREE

2026-08-28. Round two fixed comprehension completely (thirteen "Confusing" kills became zero) and **dropped the ceiling from 8.5 to 7.5**, because "one clean impossible fact" produced impossible-fact puzzles with nobody in them.

Round three keeps every clarity rule and adds the thing the two champions have and round two lost: somebody alive is paying for this, and you can see who. No line here works only because a fact is impossible. Groups are three, four or five, never sixty.

- 1 • The Money Still Arrives** Her mother has had money arrive on the same day every month since the funeral, from an account nobody can trace, and she has never once spent any of it.
- 2 • She Swore He Was Home** A woman gave her son the alibi that cleared him and has not let him in the house since.
- 3 • The Girl He Walked Home** He was the last person to see her alive, he has said so for twenty years, and every year he walks the same route on the same night.
- 4 • Her Husband's Best Friend** He carried the coffin, gave the eulogy, and moved in with her within the year, and her sister has not spoken to either of them since.
- 5 • Three Sons, One Confession** Three brothers were in the house when their father died, one confessed, and the other two have paid his legal costs for eleven years without visiting once.
- 6 • The Wrong Man Apologised** The man acquitted of killing her wrote to the family every Christmas for nine years, and the letters stopped the month somebody else was charged.
- 7 • He Testified Against His Father** At nineteen he put his father away for his mother's murder, and he has spent the fifteen years since trying to get him out.
- 8 • The House Nobody Would Buy** The family sold at a loss and moved three streets away, and the man who bought their daughter's house has been leaving her post on their doorstep for six years.
- 9 • The Witness Who Moved Away** The only witness left the country a month before the trial, paid for by somebody, and she came back the week the man she never testified against died in prison.
- 10 • Her Friend Chose the Coffin** Her family were three hours away, and by the time they arrived a friend they had never met had chosen the coffin, the flowers and the words.
- 11 • He Kept Going to the Trial** A man with no connection to anybody involved sat in the public seats for all six weeks, and he has done the same at two other trials since.
- 12 • The Neighbour Who Called It In** She rang for an ambulance, gave first aid, and held his hand until he died, and she has never once been able to say why she was in his house.
- 13 • Nobody Told His Daughter** He was murdered when she was four and the family agreed to tell her it was an accident, and she found out at twenty-six from a stranger at a wedding.
- 14 • The Second Set of Keys** Two people had keys to her flat, one of them was her killer, and the other has spent nine years insisting there were only ever two.

15 • She Paid for His Defence The dead man's sister sold her house to pay for the lawyer who got his killer acquitted, and she has never explained it to anyone in the family.

16 • The Man at Every Anniversary Every year on the day she died a man leaves a bottle of her drink at the spot, and the family have asked him twice to stop coming.

17 • A Year of Working Away A man was found dead three hundred miles from home, his wife identified him inside twenty minutes, and she had told everyone for a year that he was working away.

18 • The Friend Who Packed Her Things Her flat was cleared within four days of her death by a friend nobody in the family had heard of, and everything went into a skip.

19 • He Was Cleared and He Left He was found not guilty and moved away the same week, and his own brother has spent eleven years telling people the jury got it wrong.

20 • Three Friends, One Story Three friends said she left the party alone, all three said it in the same words, and one of them has been in touch with her mother every week since.